County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, February 9, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting ***https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/374556***

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:00 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn - Virtual
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member Gerald Dawson

2. Pledge of Allegiance

Council Member Lawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the agenda.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Lawson to amend the agenda to add time for the Treasurer, Maria Walls, to speak during item 14.a.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council

Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion to amend passed 10:0.

Main Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the agenda as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The amended motion passed 10:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the minutes from Caucus and Council on January 26, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

6. Proclamation

a. Proclamation recognizing the 250th Anniversary of the Battle of Port Royal Island — *Council Member Bartholomew*

7. Administrators Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/374556

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/374556

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee

1. Approval to purchase a dump truck with attachment package ($272,258.28)

b. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval of a contract to JH Hiers for annual dirt road paving contract #56 ($2,709,377)

2. Approval of a sole-source contract to Slurry Pavers Inc. for Year 9 pavement preservation. ($753,343.13)

3. Approval of a sole source contract to Pavement Technology for Year 9 Asphalt Rejuvenator ($375,372.31)

4. Approval of a contract to AECOM for the SC 170-US 278 Interchange Design ($591,140)

5. Approval of a contract to Platinum Paving and Concrete for Asphalt Resurfacing at County convenience centers ($301,628)

6. Approval of a contract to Black & Veatch for Arthur Horne Wetland Restoration Project Design ($491,370)

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Agenda Item

a. Public Hearing and Presentation of the 2026 Community Development Block Grant (CDBG) - *Michelle Knight, Lowcountry Council of Governments*

Michelle Knight, Lowcountry Council of Governments, presented the Community Development Block Grant for 2026.

b. Approval of supplemental funding in the amount of $40,000 for Beaufort Water Search and Rescue.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the supplemental funding in the amount of $40,000 for the Beaufort Water Search and Rescue.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. Reappointment to the Bluffton Township Fire District for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

- Joseph Paolo - Term to be served: 4th

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve the reappointment of Joseph Paolo to the Bluffton Township Fire District for a four-year term with the expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

12. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/02: An Ordinance Authorizing the County Administrator to Execute the Necessary Documents and Provide Funding for the Purchase of Real Property Located at 1451 Ribaut Road (TMS No. R110 009 000 0031 0000) from Drayton-Parker Companies LLC in the amount of $700,000 plus closing costs.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on January 20, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on January 26, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/02.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

13. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2026/03: An Ordinance authorizing the acceptance of a drainage easement located on Leo Green Rd.

The vote at Public Facilities and Safety Committee on January 20, 2026 - 10:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/03.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2026/04: An Ordinance Authorizing the Private Road Acceptance of Somerset Point Phase 2 HOA Roads—Cowbird Ct, White Ibis Dr, White Heron Dr, Tern Road S, Sandpiper Dr, Fox Sparrow Rd, and American Avocet Ct—Into the County Road Inventory.

The vote at Public Facilities and Safety Committee on January 20, 2026 - 3:7

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Passiment to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/04.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion failed 3:7.

c. 2026/05: An Ordinance authorizing the abandonment of a drainage easement recorded in Deed Book 3695 at Pages 3345-3347 & Deed Book 3695 at Pages 3348-3350 located off Gumwood Drive in northern Lady's Island.

The vote at Public Facilities and Safety Committee on January 20, 2026 - 9:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/05.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

14. Resolutions

a. 2025/63: A Resolution regarding the Beaufort County Personnel Handbook section 3.3 Remote Work/Telecommuting policy.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on October 20, 2025 - 7:0
The vote at County Council to remand the Resolution back to Finance Committee on November 10, 2025 - 11:0
The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on January 20, 2026 - 9:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to go into Executive Session.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/63.

Motion to Amend: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to amend policy 3.3 to allow for a grandfather provision for the 3 employees that are currently working virtually to continue to do so.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Glover, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment. The motion to amend passed 6:4.

Main Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/63 as amended.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Glover, and Council Member Passiment. The amended motion passed 7:3.

b. 2026/02: A Resolution to accept a South Carolina Aeronautics (SCAC) Commercial Airport Entitlement Grant in the amount of $42,625.00 for Approach Tree Mitigation at Hilton Head Island Airport (HXD) - Contingent upon final grant offer.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Reitz to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/02.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2026/03: A Resolution to accept a South Carolina Aeronautics Commission (SCAC) state-local airport development grant in the amount of $46,775.00 for design and permitting services related to the relocation of the Beaufort Executive Airport's (ARW) existing Automated Weather Observing System (AWOS) - contingent upon grant offer

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/03.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

15. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

Alice G. Howard

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

Sarah W. Brock

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: February 23, 2026